again, in the matter of the date and time of the arrests, and in the alleged seizure of the incriminating laptop and the Rs 10 lakh, we have only the word of the police, against the word of a ‘terrorist’.

The **Seizures continued:** The seized laptop, the police said, contained the files that created the fake Home Ministry pass and the fake identity cards. It contained no other useful information. They claimed that Afzal was carrying it to Srinagar in order to return it to Ghazi Baba. The Investigating Officer ACP Rajbir Singh said that the hard disk of the computer had been sealed on 16 January 2002 (a whole month after the seizure). But the computer shows that it was accessed even after that date. The courts have considered this, but taken no cognizance of it. (On a speculative note, isn’t it strange that the only incriminating information found on the computer were the files used to make the fake passes and ID cards? And a Zee TV film clip showing the Parliament Building? If other incriminating information had been deleted, why wasn’t this? And why did Ghazi Baba, Chief of Operations of an international terrorist organization, need a laptop— with bad artwork on it—so urgently? To do a spell- check perhaps?)

Consider the **Mobile Cell-phone Call Records:** Stared at for long enough, a lot of the ‘hard evidence’ produced by the Special Cell begins to look dubious. The backbone of the prosecution’s case has to do with the recovery of mobile phones, SIM cards, computerized call records, and the testimonies of officials from cell-phone companies and shopkeepers who sold the phones and SIM cards to Afzal and his accomplices. The call records that were produced to show that Shaukat, Afzal, Geelani and Mohammad (one of the dead militants) had all been in touch with each other very close to the time of the Attack, were uncertified computer printouts, not even copies of primary documents. They were outputs of the billing system, stored as text files that could have been easily doctored at any time. For example, the call records that were produced show that two calls had been made at exactly the same time from the same SIM card, but from *separate* handsets with *separate* IMEI numbers. This means that either the SIM card had been cloned or the call records were doctored.

Consider the **SIM Card:** To prop up its version of the story, the prosecution relies heavily on one particular mobile phone number—9811489429. The police say it was Afzal’s number—the number that connected Afzal to Mohammad (one of the dead terrorists), Afzal to Shaukat, and Shaukat to Geelani. The police also say that this number was written on